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Summarize the 1906 San Francisco Earthquake. What factors shaped the current landscape?

The **1906 San Francisco Earthquake** was one of the most devastating natural disasters in U.S. history. It occurred on **April 18, 1906**, with an estimated magnitude of **7.8**, along the **San Andreas Fault**. The earthquake itself caused extensive structural damage across San Francisco and neighboring areas, but the **subsequent fires**—fueled by broken gas lines and wooden buildings—wiped out large portions of the city, leaving roughly **half of San Francisco's population homeless**. Estimates suggest that **over 3,000 people died**, making it one of the deadliest earthquakes in U.S. history.

Several key factors shaped the city's current landscape:

1. **Urban Redevelopment:** After the earthquake and fires, San Francisco underwent massive reconstruction. Streets were widened, building codes were strengthened, and more fire-resistant materials, like steel and concrete, became standard. This reshaped the city's architecture and layout.
2. **Infrastructure Upgrades:** Water systems, gas lines, and electricity were modernized to prevent similar disasters.
3. **Population and Economic Shifts:** Many residents temporarily relocated, and new businesses and industries emerged during reconstruction, altering the city's demographics and economic structure.
4. **Geological Awareness:** The earthquake highlighted San Francisco's vulnerability to seismic activity, influencing future urban planning and emergency preparedness strategies.
5. **Cultural Legacy:** The disaster fostered a resilient civic identity and influenced literature, art, and public memory in the city.

Overall, the 1906 earthquake not only physically reshaped San Francisco but also transformed it socially, economically, and culturally, creating the foundation for the modern city we see today.

If you want, I can also make a **visual timeline showing the earthquake, fires, and rebuilding phases**, which makes the transformation of the landscape very clear. Do you want me to do that?

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